continued, accompanied by members of the media, to Shanghai. The highlight of our visit there was an excursion to the former Jewish synagogue, which was now a museum that documented the warm welcome and assistance extended by the Chinese to Jewish refugees who had fled the Holocaust in Europe and ended up in China.

The prime minister's most important insight from the visit to China, which I shared with him, was undeniable—the emergence of the China as a major world power, second only to the United States in terms of its global potential, both economic and military. It was clear that Israel would have to formulate its own strategy vis-à-vis China, whose main focus would be the building of a relationship that would encompass as many issues as possible on which there was a convergence of interests. I recommended to the prime minister that the Israeli ambassador to China have a status similar to that of Israel's ambassador to the United States. He or she should be the personal appointment of the prime minister, like the ambassador to Washington, and should report directly to the prime minister.

The Mossad has guided Israel's relations with Indonesia, the largest Muslim country in the world (with 250 million Muslims dispersed throughout some seventeen thousand islands) since 1963. During the "agricultural" era of Israeli foreign policy, Israeli agricultural experts, under the auspices of the Mossad, set up an impressive farm for President Sukarno. There was a dairy farm there as well, and Mossad personnel who visited Indonesia sometimes took with them small stainless-steel containers containing the semen of the best Israeli cattle in order to enhance the breeding of the cows on the farm. During that period, Israeli agriculture bolstered its relations with many countries around the world with which it did not have diplomatic relations.

Prior to the visit to Indonesia in 1993, the Mossad made great efforts to arrange a meeting between Prime Minister Rabin and President Suharto of Indonesia and succeeded when the conditions were ripe. It was agreed that the visit to Indonesia would coincide with the visit to China, which greatly complicated the logistics of the trip. The meeting with Suharto was scheduled for a Friday, at his private home in Jakarta. The prime minister's plane was scheduled to land following Friday prayers in the mosques, after the worshippers had dispersed. It was clear that we could not stay in Jakarta overnight, so we planned to fly from there to Singapore, about an hour's flight. We would have to arrive at the hotel in Singapore before the start of